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Toh 522 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 522 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Jñānolkā-nāma-dhāraṇī-sarvagati-pariśodhanī and in Tibetan as the Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Torch of Wisdom, which Thoroughly Purifies All Destinies of Beings. It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and presents a sacred formula of great ritual and soteriological power, focused on the luminous wisdom of the tathāgata Jñānolkā and associated with the purification of all states of rebirth. The text opens with a series of homages to several named tathāgatas — including Satyavākya, Suvarṇaprabhasaṃcayabhāsa, and Bhayaśabdarāja — and unfolds through the voice of the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, situating it within the broad Mahāyāna tradition of protective and purificatory scripture. A colophon note preceding the text indicates that reciting or focusing upon this dhāraṇī as an object of offering is said to be equivalent to making offerings that fill an entire world-system, underscoring the immense merit attributed to its recitation.

— made into an image or a stūpa — upon which one focuses as an object of offering, and recites it: offerings filling an entire world-system will have been made. The essence of dependent origination is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya-jñānolkā-nāma-dhāraṇī-sarvagati-pariśodhanī.

In the Tibetan language: The noble dhāraṇī called Jñānolkā — the Torch of Wisdom — which thoroughly purifies all destinies of beings.

Homage to the Omniscient One. Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas. Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Jñānolkā. Homage to the Tathāgata Suvarṇaprabhasaṃcayabhāsa — Radiance of Accumulated Golden Light. Homage to the Tathāgata Satyavākya — True Speech. Homage to the Tathāgata Bhayaśabdarāja — King who Resounds with the Sound of Fear.

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, the bodhisattva Dhāraṇīśvararāja — King among Lords of Dhāraṇī — the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, those four bodhisattvas together with those Tathāgatas, were dwelling in the abode of the moon and the sun.

Then the two sons of the gods, the Moon and the Sun, went to the place where those Tathāgatas and those bodhisattvas were dwelling, and those two beheld the Tathāgatas seated upon jewel-adorned lion thrones, and those

bodhisattvas assembled within multi-storied palaces adorned with victory banners of Jambudvīpa.

Then the two sons of the gods, the Moon and the Sun, thought to one another: How might we, through the power of these Tathāgatas and these bodhisattvas, come to bestow light upon all sentient beings and dispel darkness and deep gloom — coming to possess the intelligence that pervades the ten directions, which arises from the dhāraṇī mantra called "One whose mind pervades the ten directions."

Then those Tathāgatas and those bodhisattvas, having known with their wisdom the full scope of the thoughts in the minds of those sons of the gods, the Moon and the Sun, at that time those Tathāgatas together with those bodhisattvas declared this dhāraṇī mantra:

Syād yathā idan. Cakṣu radada. Cakṣuśubhadhulame thākalatta. Itthanś. Sūraṭṭa sūraṭṭa. Suttāya. Itthanś. Belā belā. Pāṇi carumūrtini. Āraṇi āraṇi. Kālapāṇi kālapāṇi. Duru duru. Situ rudu hasi. Dhasuti dhasuti. Dhiri dhiri. Dhura dhura. Dhuru dhuru. Kāla kāla. Satthāsa. Gīla gīla. Gīlapaya gīlapaya. Dhusu dhusu. Sundhu sundhu. Satthāsu. Atthāsu. Ethāsu. Ethāsāvāni. Yucuridhe. Sudhare. Kara kara. Kiri kiri. Kuru kuru. Kurma kurma. Kurmapāṇi kurmapāṇi. Kelu kelu. Kelapāṇi kelapāṇi. Karkāri karkāri. Laru buddhe. Dhurundhe dhurundhe. Mahādhurundhe. Kara kara. Kira kira. Pihu si pihu si. Dhasu dhasu. Hasu hasu. Hasupani svāhā.

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra spoke to the two sons of the gods, the Moon and the Sun, in these words: "O sons of good family, this dhāraṇī mantra was proclaimed by eighty-four million buddhas for the benefit of sentient beings going to the lower realms. O sons of good family, the udumbara flower is easy enough to find — but the words of this dhāraṇī mantra do not appear in the world in such a way. O sons of good family, the words of this dhāraṇī mantra are easy enough to find — but to bear and recite them is not so. O sons of good family, the arising of a buddha is easy enough to find — but the words of this dhāraṇī mantra arising in the world is not so."

O sons of good family, if sentient beings who are dwelling in the Avīci hell for an aeon, who have committed the five acts of immediate retribution, or who have abandoned the sacred Dharma — if, for the sake of those sentient beings, these words of the dhāraṇī mantra are recited twenty-one days, three times by day and three times by night, then at that time, by the power of the words of this dhāraṇī mantra, the great Avīci hell will split open into a hundred

pieces and those sentient beings will be completely liberated. What need is there even to speak of human beings of Jambudvīpa? Those in whose hearing these words resound should know with certainty: "We are held and encompassed by the four Tathāgatas, the four bodhisattvas, the Moon, and the Sun." In this there should be no doubt or second thought.

Tadyathā: dhunati dhunati mahādhunati suru suru svāhā śuklaviśodhani tara tara svāhā jyotiṣpradīpe turu turu svāhā padmālinī satyatarabuddhi huru huru svāhā satyabuddhi satyavalokini kara kara kiri kiri svāhā dharaṇapuṭi apratihata buddhi curu curu svāhā lakṣaṇicite dhūmapari hare huru huru khuru khuru svāhā dhara dhara mādharma dhara dhara dharayantiye svāhā suprati sumati apratihata buddha dhara dhara dharayantiye svāhā.

Homage to the Blessed Tathāgata Jñānatalalala. Homage to the Tathāgata Radiant Stacked Golden Light. Homage to the Tathāgata True Speech. Homage to the Tathāgata King Who Proclaims the Sound of Terror. Svāhā. Noble —

Translator's Notes

- The opening sentence is a continuation from a preceding passage about an image or stūpa as an object of offering with the recitation of the dhāraṇī; it begins mid-sentence here, so the translation reflects that continuation.

The Tathāgata epithets Suvarṇaprabhasaṃcayabhāsa, Satyavākya, and Bhayaśabdarāja are back-rendered from the Tibetan; the Sanskrit forms given are reconstructions.

The dhāraṇī syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic transcription of Sanskrit; no semantic translation of the mantra syllables is attempted, in keeping with standard practice.

The comparison of the rarity of the udumbara flower with something more common inverts the usual metaphor, where the udumbara flower is itself rare. The Tibetan reads "the udumbara flower is easy enough to find, but the words of this dhāraṇī are not like that in the world," meaning the dhāraṇī words are even rarer than that flower. The translation preserves this sense.

- The text breaks off mid-phrase at the end with "Noble —" corresponding to the Tibetan འཕགས་པའི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་ལྷན་པོ་, indicating the passage continues and has been cut. The four Tathāgata names given in the homage section are rendered as literal translations of the Tibetan: Jñānatalalala is unusual and may be a dhāraṇī-embedded epithet rather than a standard buddha name; the Tibetan འཕགས་པའི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་ལྷན་པོ་ could also represent a mantra syllable sequence appended to "Gnosis." The mantra syllables in the body of the dhāraṇī are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering and may differ from reconstructed Sanskrit originals. The five acts of immediate retribution are the classical pañcānantarya: killing one's mother, killing one's father, killing an arhat, drawing the blood of a Tathāgata, and causing a schism in the Saṅgha.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.